PROJECT 03

New Market Launch & Operational Readiness Program

PROJECT CHARTER

Simulated case study | Hybrid Agile | Microsoft Azure DevOps

1. Project Identification

Item	Definition
Project Name	New Market Launch & Operational Readiness Program
Project Type	Cross-functional Market Expansion
Classification	Simulated case study
Duration	12 weeks
Delivery Approach	Hybrid Agile
Primary Tool	Microsoft Azure DevOps
Project Manager	Program / Project Manager
Target Outcome	Launch readiness and controlled Go-Live
Launch Decision	Formal Go / No-Go

2. Business Case

The organization plans to expand its existing consumer service into a new Indian market. Previous expansion activities have been managed independently by functional teams, resulting in inconsistent ownership, limited visibility into dependencies, late identification of risks and fragmented readiness reporting.

A structured program-management approach is therefore required to coordinate the launch and provide leadership with a consolidated view of readiness.

Expected business value:

- Establish clear ownership across launch workstreams.
- Improve visibility of critical dependencies.
- Identify and mitigate launch risks earlier.
- Standardize readiness assessment.
- Improve cross-functional coordination.
- Provide leadership with data-driven launch status.
- Create a repeatable framework for future market expansions.

3. Project Objectives

Primary objective: Deliver a coordinated 12-week market-launch program that achieves operational readiness and enables an evidence-based Go/No-Go decision.

1. Establish a single integrated launch plan.
2. Define ownership across all critical workstreams.
3. Identify and manage cross-functional dependencies.
4. Track risks, issues and decisions centrally.
5. Establish measurable readiness criteria.
6. Validate operational and partner capacity.
7. Provide transparent executive reporting.
8. Capture lessons learned and create a reusable launch framework.

4. Scope

In Scope

- Integrated launch plan, milestones, workstream planning and dependency mapping.
- Operations readiness: staffing, SOPs, training and capacity.
- Partner/vendor readiness: onboarding, contracts, SLAs and capacity.
- Customer support readiness: support model, knowledge base, FAQs and escalation process.
- Marketing and GTM: messaging, campaign readiness and launch communications.
- Finance and commercial readiness: pricing, budget and billing readiness.
- Compliance and governance: approvals, controls and governance checkpoints.
- Launch and hypercare: Go/No-Go assessment, launch coordination, Day-1 monitoring and post-launch review.

Out of Scope

- Development of a new product.
- Major software engineering or underlying platform architecture.
- Product redesign.
- Long-term business operations after hypercare.
- Expansion into additional cities.
- Detailed financial forecasting beyond launch requirements.

5. Key Workstreams

Workstream	Primary Focus
Operations Readiness	Operating model, staffing, SOPs, training and capacity
Partner & Vendor Readiness	Vendor onboarding, contracting, capacity and SLAs
Customer Support Readiness	Support model, knowledge base, FAQs and escalation
Marketing & Go-to-Market	Launch messaging, campaign and communications
Finance & Commercial Readiness	Pricing, budget and billing readiness
Compliance & Governance	Approvals, controls, risk and governance checkpoints
Launch & Hypercare	Go/No-Go, launch coordination, Day-1 monitoring and hypercare

6. Key Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role / Responsibility
Executive Sponsor	Funding, strategic decisions and escalation
Program Manager	Overall delivery, coordination and reporting
Operations Lead	Operational readiness
Vendor / Partner Lead	External partner readiness
Customer Support Lead	Support readiness
Marketing Lead	GTM readiness
Finance Lead	Commercial readiness
Compliance Lead	Approvals and controls
Technology Lead	Supporting platform/system readiness
HR / Training Lead	Workforce and training
External Vendors	Delivery and capacity readiness

7. Governance Structure

Forum	Cadence	Focus
Weekly Program Review	Weekly	Status, milestones, risks, dependencies, issues and decisions
Executive Review	Biweekly	Readiness, critical path, major risks, capacity and escalations
Go/No-Go Review	Pre-launch	Integrated readiness and launch decision

8. Key Milestones

Milestone	Target
Project Kickoff	Week 1
Requirements & Readiness Criteria Confirmed	Week 2
Workstream Plans Approved	Week 3
Partner / Vendor Readiness Checkpoint	Week 5
Operational Readiness Checkpoint	Week 7
Customer Support Readiness	Week 8
Integrated Readiness Review	Week 9
Final Launch Readiness Assessment	Week 11
Go/No-Go Decision	Week 12
Launch + Hypercare	Week 12+

9. Initial Risks

ID	Risk	Impact	Probability	Initial Response
R1	Vendor capacity may be insufficient at launch.	High	Medium	Validate capacity early and establish contingency options.
R2	Cross-functional dependency delays may affect the launch.	High	High	Establish dependency mapping and weekly dependency review.
R3	Required staff may not complete training before launch.	Medium	Medium	Set training thresholds and escalation triggers.
R4	Required stakeholder approvals may be delayed.	High	Medium	Define approval owners and decision deadlines.
R5	Additional requests may enter the program close to launch.	High	Medium	Use formal change-control mechanism.

10. Constraints

- 12-week launch window.
- Limited cross-functional resources.
- Fixed target launch date.
- External vendor dependencies.
- Multiple stakeholder groups.
- Existing operating processes should be reused where practical.
- No major product redevelopment permitted.

11. Assumptions

- Existing core service/product is launch-ready.
- Required functional leads are available.
- Existing corporate policies can be adapted for the new market.
- Vendors can meet agreed SLAs.
- Required approvals can be obtained within the program timeline.
- Launch scope remains controlled.
- Azure DevOps is used as the central work-management platform.

12. Success Criteria

Measure	Target
Critical launch activities completed	≥95%
Critical dependencies resolved	100%
Mandatory training completed	≥95%
Critical vendors ready	100%
Critical compliance approvals	100%
Critical risks without mitigation	0
Launch readiness score	≥90%
Go/No-Go decision	Completed before launch
Post-launch critical incidents	Within agreed threshold

13. Go/No-Go Decision Framework

A Go decision requires evidence that:

- Critical operational capabilities are ready.
- Critical partners are ready.
- Customer-support capabilities are ready.
- Required approvals are complete.
- Critical risks are mitigated or formally accepted.
- Capacity and resources are sufficient.
- Critical-path activities are complete.

If a critical condition remains unresolved, the program proceeds to a No-Go or Conditional-Go decision requiring executive review.